**ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY**
(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle)
**KARAIKUDI**

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Date: 7.8.2017

The Inaugural Function of the One-Week Short-Term Course on "Professional Enrichment" organized by the Alagappa University College of Education, Karaikudi, was held on 7.8.2017 in the Seminar Hall of the Convocation Auditorium.

Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University, in his Presidential Address said that quality education is the most significant need of the hour. He said that American students as a matter-of-fact are more interested in getting quality education. In America, they have started quality teaching force for training quality teachers. In India, both the Central and State Governments have been spending crores of rupees for enhancing the quality of teachers for providing quality education. He emphatically stated that "if we have quality teachers, we can surely achieve what we want such as proper political, economic and social changes in the country".

He hoped that this professional enrichment programme would inculcate all those qualities that go into the making of effective professionals among the participant-teachers. Enrichment meant providing quality library

services, quality publication, using latest technology and introducing new methods of imparting education. The institution which has a quality library will excel in all its spheres. A visit to a renowned institution of learning will besides helping us in designing good infrastructure facilities and will also provide academic enrichment. Educational visits by the professionals and students will help them learn the recent trends and to introduce innovations in their professions.

The distinguished speaker said "If we are good teachers, students feel motivated to learn from us". So as teachers, we need to use our rich experiences and provide more opportunities for the learners to develop and enrich their knowledge and blossom into confident individuals. Quality publications will be read by many people. So as professionals, we have to write quality research articles and provide new knowledge to our younger generations. Teachers should know how to present themselves, they have to plan, prepare and teach effectively and get feedback simultaneously from their students. Feedback is very important to know whether we are doing our work in the right way. He hoped that this short-term course on "Professional Enrichment" will certainly help them to acquire qualities that are expected of them.

Dr. S. Mohan, Director, Centre for Research Education, Kundrakudi, in his Inaugural Address, said that Dr. Alagappa Chettiar's farsighted vision laid emphasize on making this University a global one. Academic enrichment indicators such as teaching, learning, curriculum, research consultancy, infrastructure and learning resources were well appreciated by the NAAC Peer Team during its visit to Alagappa University in April 2017. This achievement owed its success to the untiring effort of Vice-Chancellor Prof. S. Subbiah. With his unmatched enthusiasm, dedication, hard work, confidence and never say 'no' attitude, he could achieve this feat. As said by Gandhiji and Abraham Lincoln, contribution for establishing library helps for academic enrichment was rightly taken up by the Vice-Chancellor and made university library a world class one.

Prof. A. Narayanamoorthy, Member of Syndicate, Alagappa University, in his felicitation address stated that the monotonous way of teaching following the old fashioned and worn out methods is not the right way of doing one's professional work. Change in methodology, change in research and change in technology have to be incorporated for gaining academic enrichment. New teaching, new methodology can be learnt through this kind of short-term course. He added that there are various ways to enrich our professional competencies and this programme is one kind of it.

Dr. P. Sivakumar, Dean, Faculty of Education, Alagappa University, delivered the thematic address. He stated that outdated persons following outmoded methods cannot be effective professionals in this knowledge era. Teachers have to enrich themselves with recent knowledge and newer developments. Under Cognitive Neuro Science, concept map, mind map and the recent mood map, which is in the form of mobile app, are the recent developments. The professionals have to gain knowledge on those new technological developments, new instructional framework, technical and analytical knowledge and acquire leadership skills. He was sure that "the professional togetherness will also synergize us for undertaking latest research works for humanity's progress".

More than 100 participants from various parts of the State are participating in this short-term course.

Dr. A. Balu, Principal i/c., Alagappa University College of Education welcomed the gathering. Dr. M. Parimala Fathima, Assistant Professor, proposed a vote of thanks.

Registrar i/c.

Prof. V. Balachandran